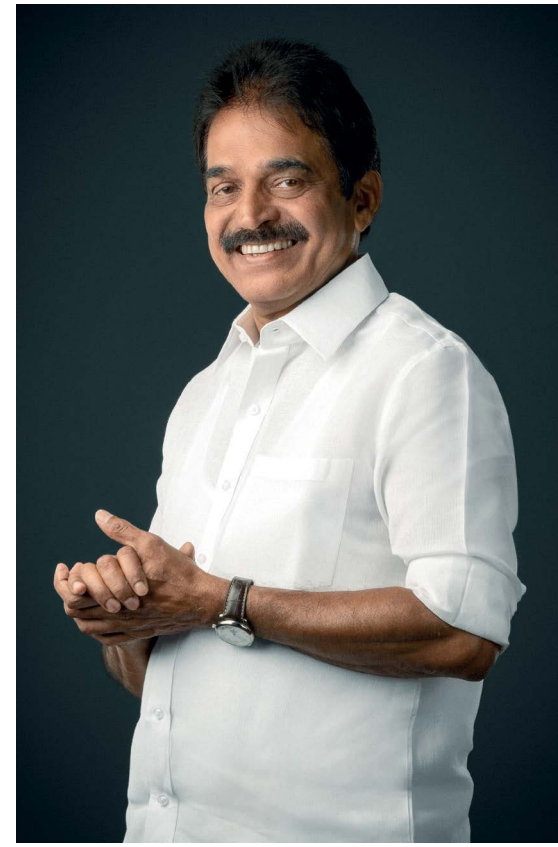
K.C. VENUGOPAL

Lok Sabha MP and Congress General Secretary (Organisation)

DECODING CONGRESS STRATEGY

The Congress is fighting not just the BJP...but the entire system, including the IT department, CBI, ED, and now even the Election Commission

I might be operating from Delhi...but I have Kerala's best interests in mind. I am not looking for any chair (on whether he was a CM post aspirant)



Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH

The Congress's Lok Sabha MP from Alappuzha in Kerala, K.C. Venugopal has been one of party leader Rahul Gandhi's closest associates in the past decade. Speaking at the 2026 India Today conclave, the Congress's general secretary-organisation started by fending off claims that he might be a power centre in the party, saying his job was "decision-routing". He also denied the Congress was on the wane, saying, "Every political party has its ups and downs. The BJP once had just two MPs, was losing every election..." The senior Congress leader accused the saffron party of weaponising every institution against political opponents, and alleged the Election Commission was also in cahoots with them.

"There is no system for free and fair election under the present EC," Venugopal said as he explained the reasons why the Opposition parties have moved the impeachment motion against the chief election commissioner (CEC). He said the party had minutely examined the electoral losses, and alleged that the findings showed that the EC had a big role in the BJP's wins. The Congress leader also said that the party had brought various discrepancies, including in the voters' list, to the notice of the commission, but "got no response from them".

The Congress MP also accused the Narendra Modi government of surrendering to the US in the trade deal negotiations, and blamed the NDA's foreign policy for the evolving LPG crisis across the country amidst the war in West Asia. On a parting note, Venugopal was asked if he harboured aspirations of becoming the Kerala chief minister (in the event that the party won the assembly election in April). As becomes a veteran politician, Venugopal deftly sidestepped the question, saying he was a proud Keralite with the state's best interests at heart but was not aspiring for any such post right now. ■

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- **The Congress is still the strongest party. It has activists in every village**
- **All our institutions are compromised, including the Election Commission**
- **Democracy is in peril in India, and the Congress must lead the fightback**
- **The party is introspecting on its election losses, and strengthening the organisation**